Gemcitabine alone: nasopharyngeal cancer

Gemcitabine is used to control the cancer and relieve symptoms. Your team discusses expected benefit, alternatives and when to review whether treatment is helping.

Head and neck: nasopharyngeal cancer · NCCP 00514 v3 · Document revised 11 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

The team reviews symptoms, side effects and response. Treatment may finish earlier if it is no longer helping or causes unacceptable problems.

My overall treatment

Days 1 and 8; every 21 days; up to 6 cycles.



Treatment
Gemcitabine 1,250 mg/m² on Days 1 and 8 every 21 days, for up to 6 cycles or until progression or unacceptable side effects.

Review / next phase
The team reviews symptoms, side effects and response. Treatment may finish earlier if it is no longer helping or causes unacceptable problems.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–7	Day 8	Day 9–21
treatment	Between the first two visits	gemcitabine	Recovery and next review

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline preparation** NCCP / individual plan	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms.
During	**Required tests** NCCP	Full blood count before each treatment; kidney and liver blood tests before each cycle.
After / response	**Recovery and next step** Individual plan	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.

Between treatments

- Side effects can occur on any day. Keep prescribed support medicines and contact details to hand.
- Call promptly for fever or sudden illness, new breathing symptoms, persistent vomiting or inability to drink.

Bring your medicines list, appointment calendar and verified urgent contacts.

When to get help
Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.
Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321
EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Fatigue and concentration

Gemcitabine

Tiredness can affect activity and concentration. Balance activity and rest; report sudden confusion.

2 Mouth and swallowing

Gemcitabine

Report soreness, ulcers or difficulty swallowing. Ask early about mouth care, pain relief and nutrition.

3 Breathing

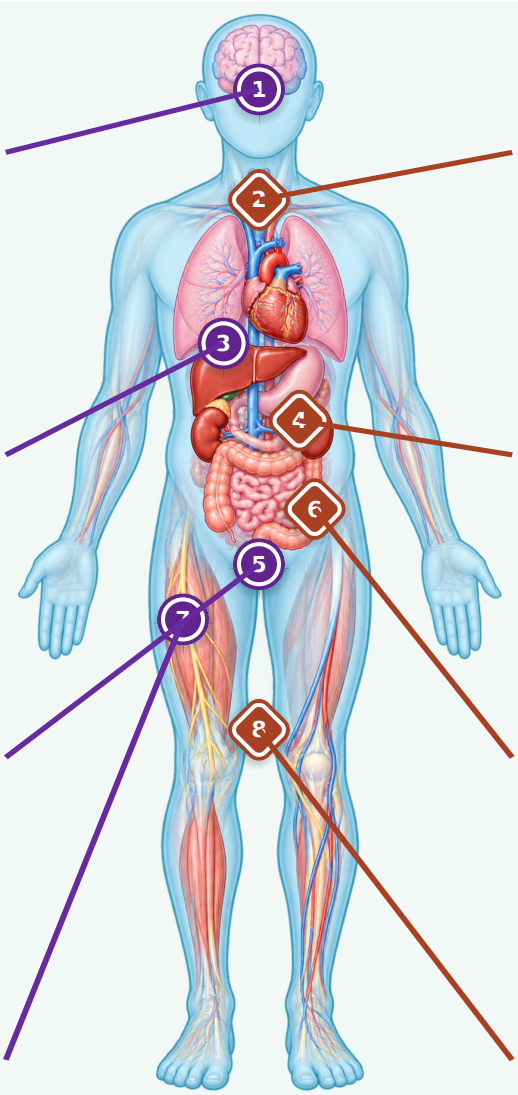
Gemcitabine

New or worsening breathlessness, cough or chest symptoms need urgent advice; lung inflammation can be serious.

4 Blood and infection

Gemcitabine

Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unexplained bruising or bleeding needs urgent oncology advice.



5 Sickness and bowels

Gemcitabine

Take prescribed anti-sickness medicines. Report persistent vomiting, diarrhoea, dehydration or inability to drink.

6 Kidneys and fluid balance

Gemcitabine

Report reduced urine, swelling or poor fluid intake. Blood tests help detect kidney injury.

7 Skin and infusion reactions

Gemcitabine

Report severe rash, blistering, facial swelling or breathing symptoms promptly. Tell staff about pain at the infusion site.

8 Fertility and pregnancy

Gemcitabine

Discuss fertility preservation, contraception, pregnancy and breastfeeding before treatment.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bleeding, new breathlessness, persistent vomiting or inability to drink needs urgent oncology advice. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure is an emergency: call 112/999.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

Keep your treatment details to hand

Head and neck: nasopharyngeal cancer · NCCP 00514 v3 · Document revised 11 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Gemcitabine 1250

Days 1 and 8; every 21 days; up to 6 cycles.

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials
C4	C5	C6
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____
Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.